

☆ pillars of a birth partner ☆

Birth partners have a significant role; there are 5 pillars: Information; Advocacy; Practical; Physical and Emotional support.



Information:

- Learn everything you can about pregnancy and birth.
- Attend hypnobirthing classes, learn the techniques, understand how birth works, source evidence based information to guide your preferences.



Advocacy:

- Listen to your pregnant partner and respect their wishes.
- Communicate on their behalf, when they cannot.
- Be the go between for the HCP and your partner.
- Ask the questions to feel supported in your choices. Hold space for your partners preferences.

Practical:

- Dry run of the hospital journey or birth space set up if home birth- know where to park and how to pay for it, what entrance to to use etc.
- Help to pack bags to ensure you know where everything is when its needed
- Pack the car to travel.
- Set up birth space at home or other setting with affirmations, comfort items, lights etc.
- Do birth preference together and know what everything means and why it has been chosen.
- Create a playlist or two for the day, uplifting for early labour and calming for later on.



Physical:

- Soothe with touch through the use of massage or counter pressure
- Help to create a calm environment, like dimming lights using senses
- Assisting with water therapy (shower, tub)
- Applying warmth or cold
- Assisting the birthing person in walking to and from the bathroom
- Giving food, and drinks



- Emotional:
- Continuous presence and reassurance
- Encouragement
- Praise
- Helping the birthing person see themselves or their situation more positively
- Keeping company
- Mirroring - breathing, relaxation and calm
- Accepting what the birthing person wants
- Use affirmations

